



DISCUSSION GUIDE

Kara Powell

3 Big Questions that Change Every Young Person

Kara is the Executive Director of the Fuller Youth Institute and a faculty member of Fuller Theological Seminary. She is the author of several books designed to help adults ask better questions and develop deeper faith relationships with the young people in their lives.

REFLECT

1. Kara begins by voicing teenagers' frequent complaint about the church: "I'm tired of the church answering questions I'm not asking." What might such questions be, and why might the church attempting to answer these unhelpful questions?
2. Kara connects the concerns of young people (identity, belonging, and purpose) to broader issues of being human; all people regardless of age need to answer these questions. Think of a time when you have answered these questions for yourself and how the process impacted your life:
 - You struggled to identify or understand your own identity?
 - You felt displaced by a lack of belonging to a community?
 - You discovered you had something to give or help someone else?

RESPOND

3. Kara describes Gen Z (the generation born after 2000) as the most diverse, adaptive, anxious, and most empathetic generation yet. For the church to minister to and include this population, Kara argues that the church needs to become the most empathetic church yet.
 - In what areas do you see the church in general need to develop more empathy?
 - In your local community, with what situations or demographics does the local church need to cultivate such compassionate solidarity?
4. Kara insists that young people desperately need and desire good mentoring from the adults in their lives. What gifts or abilities do you have that could become areas of hospitality—places in your life you could invite young people in?